

The Spirit of Religion III

Open to John 17. We will begin around verse 19 again.

Hallelujah.

We have been talking a lot about His glory. When I slipped into the Spirit and got a look at it for the first time by revelation, I saw His glory as in the born-again trail. Lately we have been getting a look into a lot of things according to the born-again trail: fasting, worship, faith. This is one of the strongest revelations I have had outside of the revelations before the born-again trail.

Worship as in the born-again trail was one of the greatest revelations that came to me. Now it is the glory as in the born-again trail.

In other words, us in our humanity giving Him, and seeing Him in, His glory. Giving Him all the glory, as much as we can give Him on this side of redemption, in these bodies, doing His work. Seeing Him glorified as Redeemer in who He is and what He is in our midst right now. That is the glimpse I got to look at.

As you know, a grief of mine for years has been all those twisted children that our covenant seems to include, but that all who teach on it seem to leave out. It is no small wonder that the most popular issue under our covenant, as they call it, would be finances.

It seems that the more of the Father's heart I uncover, the more His heart leans the other way, that this issue should not have been left out.

Getting a glimpse of His glory, I knew that when He is totally glorified in our midst, none of those kinds of diseases can live there.

You are talking about getting excited.

The next thing I knew, John 17 opened up, and all those verses about being in Him and Him in us began to open up.

In passing review briefly for where we want to go this morning, let us read these verses one more time.

John 17:18 says:

As Thou hast sent Me into the world, even so have I also sent them into the world.

Then:

And for their sakes I sanctify Myself, that they also might be sanctified through the truth.
Neither pray I for these alone, but for them also which shall believe on Me through their word.

So this prayer He is praying in John 17 was prayed for us also, because we believed on Him through their word. This prayer Jesus prayed for us.

You do not have any trouble believing that a prayer Jesus prayed for you will come to pass, do you? Would you not think any prayer Jesus prayed for you and me would come to pass? Certainly.

Look at it again:

Neither pray I for these alone...

Those who were with Him.

...but for them also which shall believe on Me through their word.

Now what is He praying for us? Verse 21:

That they all may be one; as Thou, Father, art in Me, and I in Thee, that they also may be one in Us: that the world may believe that Thou hast sent Me.

And the glory which Thou gavest Me I have given them; that they may be one, even as We are one:

I in them, and Thou in Me, that they may be made perfect in one; and that the world may know that Thou hast sent Me, and hast loved them, as Thou hast loved Me.

Even though this is Jesus' prayer, as you will notice, it is still conditional and dependent on your will and how much you let Him on the inside.

I have not been able to preach about anything else except that free moral agency you and I have. It seems that our individuality is the most highly held and respected attribute that not only you and I have, but all creation has.

If Lucifer had been destroyed in the rebellion, then he would not have been there to add to Adam's rebellion in the garden. If Adam had been slapped down and prevented, there would not be hundreds of thousands of people in hell. Yet neither one of them was overpowered or stopped by force before entering rebellion.

So free moral agency is not only highly respected in our creation; we seem to have enough evidence to know that, in the eons of times past, God has dealt with any creation with the same respect.

Even with that kind of respect, to him that believeth, all that God is has been made possible. He paid for our free moral agency by the blood of Jesus, meaning that if any of us choose, we can choose God unrestrainedly, with no restriction, with all our life, all our heart, all our soul, and all our strength.

He said all that heaven has is possible to you. He will not withhold anything. He will put Himself on display to all humanity. He will glorify His presence in our midst. Not only that, the same love He loved Jesus with will also be demonstrated on us and in our midst: in the midst of disease, war, perplexity. It does not matter.

All that heaven has, through the blood of Jesus, has been assured to anyone who has faith to stand up in the face of Satan and all adversity and say, "I believe."

Then He will come and stop the storm.

But if you back away and do not believe, then God has to stand there. He will let you die. He will let you get killed. He will let disease kill you. He will let your neighbors kill you. With the same respect that all things are possible to him that believeth, nothing is possible to him who does not.

That is the price that was paid.

One question lingered with me that He answered this month. I was unable to understand why the sincerity of a person, when they have a half-truth and are caught in a religion where they are born again, does not give God the right to step in.

They will take that half-truth and sell out so severely that those of us who are supposed to have all the truth, who are filled with the Holy Ghost, walking in His power, with the revelation gift and the whole Word of God at our disposal, with all the translations available at our fingertips, are put to shame by their walk.

Holy men have made pilgrimages to the mountains to camp in caves and spend their lives in prayer. Figures throughout history have given their whole lives in one form of doctrine or another.

In particular, there was one nun who was so penance-minded that not only did she scrub leper colonies down, but the skin she scrubbed off them, she would pour into a golden communion cup and take it in communion. If you believe in penance, meaning that through your own suffering you are purified, then the worse the suffering gets, the more pure you become.

So everybody glorified God in her agonizing death as the pain in her stomach was unbearable in her last days.

It seems like a person that sincere would give God a right to show up in the nighttime and say, "You are believing all wrong, sweetie pie. You are just believing all wrong."

You wonder, because you look at your own life, and sometimes it looks like God gives a guy so much who hardly did anything. Then you look at this other person who is losing their life in some work, somewhere in prayer, and it looks like they hardly receive anything.

Some of these things were hard to understand. When I asked God, "Did not that alone give You the right to show up?" He said to me, "What makes you think I have not?"

You look at somebody like her, and it makes you feel ashamed to even pray and ask for anything.

"What makes you think I did not visit her?"

He did.

Here is the strength of the spirit of religion. He did visit her. But the spirit of religion is by far the strongest, most powerful deceptive spirit. It has neutralized entire nations when it was able to bring them under the tyranny of one dictator or one religion. Men will kill you in defense of their religion.

For thousands of years, Satan has camped on people so that when they come to the age of accountability, the religion of their fathers is waiting for the rest of their lives under this spirit of religion, and then to escort them at the end of life into hell.

That is the strength of the spirit of religion.

Keturah was Abraham's second wife. He married her after the death of Sarah at 127 years old and had six sons. These six sons undoubtedly journeyed to the east. Abraham gave them large gifts because they would not inherit with Isaac, and sent them to the east.

I believe they populated India. Take the middle part out of Abraham's name, and they were probably that Brahmin caste: Abraham, Brahmin. Whether that is so or not, that religion was alive when Thomas visited India. They were the ones who had him killed.

Nevertheless, the important thing is that the father of India, whoever he was, was surely taught by Ham, Shem, and Japheth. When the ark landed, they taught sacrifice.

But the Brahmin caste was strong, and they are the ones who killed Thomas.

You talk about the strength of religion. That is the strength of the spirit of religion.

There is something else I have wondered about. Sometimes we find that men of God who had miracle ministries, such as the late A. A. Allen, had very controversial lives. People who knew him best came forward and said he did have a problem. They said his liver had been destroyed by cirrhosis, that it failed on him. Some said it was because of alcohol.

Whether he drank or not is neither here nor there. I am just glad to hear from a man of God that he is in heaven.

I knew a man who worked with him, and he told me Allen had a problem. Others told me that he had a problem.

Here we have a man who supposedly has a problem, yet there are other men who live such clean lives. I call them squeaking deacons. Have you ever scrubbed your skin until it squeaked? So I call them squeaking deacons. Their lives are so pure, so holy, that you could not get them to do

anything wrong.

Yet if you want a miracle, you have to go to the other guy's service, the one with some beer bottles outside his trailer. If you want a miracle, you have to go there, because squeaking deacon cannot get you one.

Am I advocating something? No, no.

Since finding out about the grace of God, first the devil tried to get me to use grace for that doctrine that no matter what you do, your righteousness is separated from your flesh and your works. He tried to get me into that doctrine of, "It does not matter what sin you do. Once saved, always saved."

But the further I got into grace, the more I appreciated it with everything in me. The further I got into God and grace, the more I wanted to serve Him because I fell in love with Him. Not because of how far grace could reach the other way to cover and forgive, but because the more I found out about Him, the more of Him I wanted.

Sure, grace will cover a lot of your promiscuousness, faults, and sin, but that is the weak side of grace. Grace will also take you all the way into God and give you the strength to serve Him in the face of every adversity, every sin, and every trial.

Grace is also your strength not to sin.

Hallelujah.

For a while there was a doctrine that went out that it really did not matter, and men of God were using their miracles and works to prove it.

I do not know what you think about drinking, or the occasional little sip of wine around the holidays. But I can tell you the overall thought in America since those early revivals, Carrie Nation, and all who went on personal vendettas against drinking, the filthiness, and the families destroyed by it. The evolving of our religion and holiness roots said drinking went hand in hand with gambling and all of that.

So in the overall mind of a Christian, drinking is not accepted. Some are on personal crusades to change that. But what would you think if you found me sitting in a restaurant drinking a beer? Where would your mind go? It would go weird, would it not? It would tilt.

Not because the beer itself would hurt you, but because of what it symbolizes.

"I just do not care. I cannot get into legalism."

Listen, if my meat or my food causes my brother to stumble, I will not partake of any of it as long as this world stands. It is a small price to pay to have somebody come in.

"I just will not let anybody see me."

Just as sure as you do that, a little bird will fly from your window. Then you will be a hypocrite.

Grace is not designed to see how much you can get by with. His grace is sufficient, but not for you if you are using grace with that in mind. You have already made a mistake.

I love it when Paul talked about the sufficiency of His grace. He said, "Because of the abundance of my revelations, there was given to me a thorn in the flesh." Three times he sought God, and God kept telling him, "My grace is sufficient."

Paul made a discovery about grace: in the middle of perplexity, distress, torture, betrayal, and weakness, he would glorify God. When he was at his weakest point, when in the flesh there were no answers, when they were breaking his bones, whipping him, the ship had gone down, he was in the ocean with no island in sight, in the deep a day and a night, false brethren had betrayed him, and thirty men had taken a vow not to eat until he was dead, he found something.

He said, "I take pleasure in distresses, perplexities, and necessities, because when I am weakest, then I am strongest." It causes God's grace to come through.

When I lost all dependency and all avenues, and there was no way out the flesh could afford me, the least Jesus did was come in, stand by my side, and make Himself real to me. I am free.

Hallelujah.

I would rather take a spell in prison for righteousness' sake and have Jesus materialize and stand by my side and comfort me than run all over the nation with no power.

One time, when I was meditating on the Tullianum, the Mamertine Prison, I understand that Attila the Hun lost his mind in that prison as a prisoner. The conditions were so bad that even a warmonger could not stand under them, and he went mad.

Nevertheless, Paul took his tour in that prison under the system of Rome, and he was chained. When I got to that part, writing a letter and praying, I slipped over into the Spirit for a moment. It was one of those kinds of visions. I saw it. In fact, I got out in it and then snapped out before I realized what had happened.

It looked like Jesus was serving Paul communion in that place. That would be worth a tour, I think.

Hallelujah.

I love the side of grace that gives me strength, not the side that excuses.

I could not understand why a man could have one foot in the world and have miracles, while squeaking deacon, who is so polite he is always opening the door for his wife, cannot get anybody a miracle.

"You go first."

"Oh no, you go first."

"No, you go first."

Painfully polite. You just want to snap him because he does not even raise his voice. But if you need a miracle, you have to go to A. A. Allen's meeting.

I could not understand that, but I do now.

Jesus said:

There is no man which shall do a miracle in My name, that can lightly speak evil of Me.

This is where that spirit of religion comes in. You can take a man who has lapses to the flesh, like Allen obviously did. He had lapses to the flesh. Even though he had a problem with the flesh, he loved God with his spirit. He had received a miracle gift. You could not convince him God would not do miracles. He loved God, but he had problems with the flesh and obviously did not know how to overcome them.

Nobody questioned the fact that he loved God or that the Holy Ghost was working in him with power.

But squeaking deacon over here: no man can lightly speak evil of Me and do a miracle in My name. If you do not believe what He said, then He cannot do anything.

Even people who believe what He said at certain levels, though they have trouble in the flesh, He will go on and use them for periods of time. I have seen it, and it has been confusing, but I understand now.

When I was having my worst time, it did not mean I did not still love God. To the degree I loved God, I hated the weaknesses in me. God, I hated them. But there did not seem to be anything I could do about them. At the same time, I loved God with my spirit. If I walked into the service, God would show up, and I hated the things I did outside the service.

Thank God, now I have found out about His peace, where prayer in tongues will continue to bring you. Thank God I do not have to do those things anymore.

Glory to God.

There was never a time in my walk, even when it got messed up for a time, that I did not love Him. I loved Him, and I hated myself for any weaknesses I had. They were genuine weaknesses. I hated them, but there did not seem to be anything I could do about them.

Thank God for praying and fasting.

Hallelujah. Hallelujah. Hallelujah, Jesus.

The spirit of religion is very, very powerful. When people sell out to the level of truth they understand but then spend the rest of their lives serving error, God has to step out of it and let them do what they will do.

"But they are so sincere."

Yes. Their sincerity is serving the error.

This is the part where I thought, "God, do You not have a right to step in?"

He does. He tries to present them with truth.

This is why I thank God for the revelation gift of praying in tongues, where He gets to bypass what I am and everything I believe and go right to the power plant. The only permission He needs from me is permission to pass that supernatural language of tongues through my spirit and out of my mouth. That gives heaven the right to answer it.

From the inside out, He starts declaring war on every false limb, every false doctrine, every false belief. He declares war on it. Then He goes after your bad habits and your sin. He goes after them with a maliciousness.

I can always see when it starts hitting some of you. I especially like it the first time the Holy Ghost begins to indoctrinate you to the fact that your life is not your own and your money is not your own.

"Oh, I am going to have to find a church that believes the way I do."

Not only that, you are going to have to quit praying now. Throw yourself at the mercy of that fellow and hope he is right.

Hallelujah.

I can hardly stand it. I guess somebody is going to have to help me.

Oh, I thank You, Father of heaven and earth.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

How I glorify You. How I glorify You, Jesus.

Glory be to God.

Hallelujah.

Okay, I think I can make it.

Thank You, Jesus.

Looking at John 17 again, verse 20:

Neither pray I for these alone, but for them also which shall believe on Me through their word.

That is me. So, Jesus, I receive this prayer:

That they all may be one; as Thou, Father, art in Me, and I in Thee, that they also may be one in Us: that the world may believe that Thou hast sent Me.

We taught briefly what it means that Thou art in Me, and I in Thee, and they are one in Us. We will have to return to it for an in-depth study.

By one man, sin entered into the world, and death by sin. In that one man's transgression, all have sinned. The whole world inherited spiritual death from Adam, meaning we were baptized into his death.

Now the second Adam has come. The same way we were baptized into Adam by spiritual death, now that we have been born again, we have been baptized into Jesus' life. We are one in Him through that new nature. He is one in us. We are one in the Father, and it is all through that new nature He was talking about.

I love this:

I in them, and Thou in Me.

As the Father had life within Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself, and the Son has given to us to have life within ourselves. In this way, we are one with the Father. He is one with us. I in them, they in Me.

He said:

I go to prepare a place for you. And if I go, I will come again, and receive you unto Myself; that where I am, there ye may be also.

As we studied, the place He prepared was not nailing golden two-by-fours on some mansion. The way He went was through the cross.

"In My Father's house are many rooms." Jesus knew because He occupied one of them in His humanity. He was the Son of God. Then He came to get you and me by way of the cross. Now He says, "Where I am," that place He occupies with the Father, "I now receive you, that where I am, you may be also."

Jesus occupies in His humanity that room with His Father. He came and received me unto Himself, and now I occupy the same room with the Father that He occupies.

"Where I am, there shall also My servant be."

Now go to Matthew 10. Follow me closely. Let us begin with verse 23:

But when they persecute you in this city, flee ye into another: for verily I say unto you, Ye shall not have gone over the cities of Israel, till the Son of man be come.

I will address later what coming He is talking about here, because there were not too many cities in Israel to be covered. Nevertheless, the instructions Jesus gave were as much for us as for the original twelve, whom He pulled aside, gave power over unclean spirits and diseases, and sent out.

He said, "I do not want you to go anywhere but to the lost sheep of Israel." He said that before they reached the end of this journey, the Son of Man would come back. Nevertheless, the instructions He gave them when He put His mantle on them are also the same instructions to us when we receive the mandate to go into all the world.

Keep that in mind for what He is about to say. Even though He was talking to His twelve, and later the seventy who went out, and even though He was fulfilling the old covenant, He was preaching and teaching the principles of the new. So the instructions He gave the twelve belong to us just as much as they belonged to them.

Notice carefully what He begins to say in verse 24:

The disciple is not above his master, nor the servant above his lord.

The word disciple means disciplined follower, one who has disciplined himself to follow his teacher. The disciple is not above his master, his teacher, or the one who has mastered the teaching the disciple is receiving. The one being taught is not above his teacher or master.

Nor is the slave above his lord.

Is it not interesting that He divided these two? He said the disciple, the one being taught, is not above the one teaching him, his master. But a slave is not above his lord.

Who was He talking about? Himself.

Look at verse 25:

It is enough for the disciple that he be as his master, and the servant as his lord.

It is enough for the disciple, the one being taught, to become as his teacher. It is enough for the slave to occupy that place of his lord.

"Where I am," He said, "I will come again and receive you unto Myself, that where I am, there you may be also."

I am His disciple. I will occupy that place of being taught until I can become a slave and occupy that place where He is Lord.

Boy, I like this.

It is enough for the disciple to be as his teacher and the slave as his lord. It is enough for you to be on this earth in ministry as Jesus.

Now notice what He says:

If they have called the master of the house Beelzebub, how much more shall they call them of his household?

Fear them not therefore.

When they call you the devil, persecute you, speak all manner of evil against you, throw you in prison, take your stuff, and beat you up, He says it is enough that the slave is as his lord. If they called the Lord these things, persecuted Him, and called Him the devil, and now they turn around and call you the devil for following Him, what is your reward?

It is enough for you to be as your Lord.

"How can I stand up under all this persecution?"

He already told you. It is enough that you can walk as your Lord.

"But you do not know what they did to me."

He already told you. It is enough that you be as your Master and as your Lord. You get to share in the persecution. If they called the Master of the household Beelzebub, what are they going to call those of His household?

"What do I get out of it?"

It is enough. It is enough that you be as your Lord.

Let the devil call me the devil. Let him persecute me. I do not care. It is enough of a reward to be able to walk like my Lord.

Hallelujah.

Look again:

The disciple is not above his master, nor the servant above his lord.

It is enough for the disciple that he be as his master, and the servant as his lord.

If they have called the master of the house Beelzebub, how much more shall they call them of his household?

Fear them not therefore: for there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed; and hid, that shall not be known.

What I tell you in darkness, that speak ye in light: and what ye hear in the ear, that preach ye upon the housetops.

In other words, you are going to be just like your Master, your Teacher, and you will have the information to become just like your Lord.

He is telling the twelve, "There is nothing hidden that will not be manifested, anything kept secret that will not be revealed. Anything I have taught you while you were spiritually dead, in darkness, a day is coming soon when you are going to be born again and illuminated. You are going to become just like your Lord, which is Me. I want you to preach that in light, by the illumination of the born-again spirit, by the power of the Holy Spirit. What I have told you in the ear, in the closet, all these times I have taught you privately, I want you to take it and shout it from the housetops."

You do not have to have any fear because you have become like your Lord. You do not have to fear anyone who can kill the body. You do not have to fear persecution. The only One you have to fear is the Lord your God, for He is the One who has the power of your judgment.

You are soon going to become like your Lord, and all that I taught you while you were spiritually dead, you will proclaim to the whole world in light.

Hallelujah.

I have been born again.

I always wondered what those verses meant. I could not quite connect it. What do You mean that You spoke in darkness? It is when He taught the outside in parables and then gathered the core group together and expounded all things. He is saying, "All of this I have taught you in darkness, when you are born again, you are going to proclaim all of this in light."

So it is enough that the slave be as his lord. It is enough.

Notice again:

Fear them not therefore: for there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed; and hid, that shall not be known.

What I tell you in darkness, that speak ye in light: and what ye hear in the ear, that preach ye upon the housetops.

They used to get up on the tops of the flat houses and proclaim messages and make their speeches. To us, that is television and broadcasting. That is what it means to us.

Boy, are we going to shout it from the housetops.

He said:

And fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul.

But rather fear Him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell.

There is only one Person who has that kind of power. The devil may excite the killing of your body. He can kill your body, but there is not a thing he can do with your spirit.

Jesus said you do not need to fear any persecution, anything anybody is doing that comes against you. He included death in here. Why are you afraid of them killing you? There is only one Person you need to fear. It is not your enemy. There is just one. Fear Him who, after you have died, is able to preside over your judgment, and you end up in hell.

Fear Him. You do not have to fear anything else, just Him, which is God. That is not the wrong kind of fear. It is the reverent kind that weighs your walk against every circumstance and says, "I have nothing in this world to be afraid of. There is only One I fear, and that is God. My life is in His hands."

When He says it is enough for the disciple to be as his teacher and enough for the slave to be as his lord, and that if they called the Master, Jesus, the devil, they will call those who follow Him the devil, He says you have received enough when you become a slave and become as your Lord.

How so?

Because the next verses say there is nothing covered that will not be revealed, nothing kept secret from you that will not be illuminated. Therefore, "What I spoke to you in darkness, proclaim in light. What I spoke to you in the ear, in the closet, shout from the housetops."

Then He says:

Are not two sparrows sold for a farthing? and one of them shall not fall on the ground without your Father.

But the very hairs of your head are all numbered.

Fear ye not therefore, ye are of more value than many sparrows.

He is trying to get something over to you. Not one sparrow falls to the ground or has a need without your Father knowing it. Two of them cost one-sixteenth of a day's wage. The very hairs on your head are numbered.

He is trying to help you understand that once you are illuminated, nothing is hidden anymore. Nothing is kept secret from you anymore. You will become just like your Lord, and you will have nothing to fear.

How can a person fear lack when you have accessibility to be as your Lord? He said you have no need to fear anything. What do you have to be afraid of?

Greater is He who is in you than he who is in this world.

What do you have to fear?

He continues:

Whosoever therefore shall confess Me before men, him will I confess also before My Father which is in heaven.

But whosoever shall deny Me before men, him will I also deny before My Father which is in heaven.

Think not that I am come to send peace on earth: I came not to send peace, but a sword.

For I am come to set a man at variance against his father, and the daughter against her mother, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.

And a man's foes shall be they of his own household.

He that loveth father or mother more than Me is not worthy of Me: and he that loveth son or daughter more than Me is not worthy of Me.

And he that taketh not his cross, and followeth after Me, is not worthy of Me.

He that findeth his life shall lose it: and he that loseth his life for My sake shall find it.

He that receiveth you receiveth Me, and he that receiveth Me receiveth Him that sent Me.

He that receiveth a prophet in the name of a prophet shall receive a prophet's reward; and he that receiveth a righteous man in the name of a righteous man shall receive a righteous man's reward.

And whosoever shall give to drink unto one of these little ones a cup of cold water only in the name of a disciple, verily I say unto you, he shall in no wise lose his reward.

Is this not interesting? What He told them in darkness, one day they would understand and be able to proclaim to the whole world in light. So He used simple things like the hairs of your head being numbered. He knows you that well. Not one sparrow falls to the ground or has a need without Him being aware of it.

He is trying to help you understand that once you are illuminated, nothing is hidden anymore. Nothing is kept secret from you anymore. You will become just like your Lord, and you will have nothing to fear.

You have accessibility to be as your Lord.

What do you have to fear?

Closing statement.

Had I not gotten on the born-again trail, I undoubtedly would not have understood all these things. He promised me that all He ever promised me in the Word, I would find on this trail, and all the personal promises, I would find coming to pass on this trail.

When I asked Him, "Where are Your greatest answers? Why is everybody not walking in all of this?" He said, "They are in the verses most of us do not understand."

That turned out to be true.

I would not have understood these things had He not gotten me onto the born-again trail. One of the last sweet assurances I got was when He said to me, "Had you not understood inheritance, son, you would not have been able to touch the world with My truth. You would have been dependent on limited men who have limited Me. If you were dependent on limited men who have limited Me, they would be depending on a preacher who has limited Me, because he has limited himself to limited men who have limited Me."

I am learning. I am learning, and the limit is coming off.

Hallelujah.

If it is enough for the slave to be as his master, I guess so, because He showed exactly how I would become like Him. There is nothing hidden that will not be illuminated, nothing kept secret from you.

What I taught you when you were not born again, you are going to proclaim with great understanding in light.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Yes, and nothing to fear.

Glory be to God.